2026 Holiday Calendar

Published by Ella Brooks (Office Manager) and Marco Bianchi (Head of People). Last updated 6 January 2026.

Each office follows its own public holidays. You get the public holidays of the office in your employment contract, wherever you happen to be working that day. Public holidays are on top of your annual leave: 27 days in the UK, and 25 days in Portugal and Ireland.

1. London (England)

Date	Day	Holiday
1 January	Thursday	New Year's Day
3 April	Friday	Good Friday
6 April	Monday	Easter Monday
4 May	Monday	Early May bank holiday
25 May	Monday	Spring bank holiday
31 August	Monday	Summer bank holiday
25 December	Friday	Christmas Day
28 December	Monday	Boxing Day (substitute day, as 26 December is a Saturday)

8 days in total.

2. Lisbon (Portugal)

Date	Day	Holiday
1 January	Thursday	Ano Novo (New Year's Day)
17 February	Tuesday	Carnaval (granted by Kestrel; not a statutory holiday)
3 April	Friday	Sexta-feira Santa (Good Friday)
5 April	Sunday	Páscoa (Easter Sunday)
25 April	Saturday	Dia da Liberdade (Freedom Day)
1 May	Friday	Dia do Trabalhador (Labour Day)
4 June	Thursday	Corpo de Deus (Corpus Christi)
10 June	Wednesday	Dia de Portugal
13 June	Saturday	Santo António (Lisbon municipal holiday)
15 August	Saturday	Assunção de Nossa Senhora (Assumption)
5 October	Monday	Implantação da República (Republic Day)
1 November	Sunday	Todos os Santos (All Saints' Day)
1 December	Tuesday	Restauração da Independência
8 December	Tuesday	Imaculada Conceição
25 December	Friday	Natal (Christmas Day)

Portuguese holidays that fall at a weekend are not moved to a weekday. In 2026 that applies to 5 April, 25 April, 13 June, 15 August and 1 November.

3. Dublin (Ireland)

Date	Day	Holiday
1 January	Thursday	New Year's Day
2 February	Monday	St Brigid's Day
17 March	Tuesday	St Patrick's Day
6 April	Monday	Easter Monday
4 May	Monday	May bank holiday
1 June	Monday	June bank holiday
3 August	Monday	August bank holiday
26 October	Monday	October bank holiday
25 December	Friday	Christmas Day
28 December	Monday	St Stephen's Day (substitute day, as 26 December is a Saturday)

Good Friday is not a public holiday in Ireland. The Dublin office is open on 3 April 2026.

4. Winter closure

All three offices close from Tuesday 29 December to Thursday 31 December 2026. These 3 days are given by Kestrel and do not come out of your annual leave. Offices reopen on Monday 4 January 2027 (Friday 1 January is New Year's Day in all three countries).

On-call rotas, Customer Success support and payments operations keep running through the closure. If you work on a closure day, you get the day back as time off in lieu, to be taken by 31 March 2027.

5. Busy periods to avoid for leave

These are not blackout dates, but managers may decline leave requests in them:

Team	Period	Why
Finance	First 5 working days after each quarter end	Quarter-end close
Payments Engineering	Last 2 business days of each month	Payroll payout peak
Customer Success	23 November to 4 December 2026	Black Friday and Cyber Monday volumes
Engineering	18 December 2026 to 4 January 2027	Change freeze: on-call cover must be kept

Book leave in Kestrel People. The Leave Policy in /HR/Policies sets out notice periods and carry-over.